GRADE 12 / History / English

# Civil resistance and historical argument

## 01 Understand

Learning goals: Connect protest to its historical context • Use evidence to support an argument • Assess source usefulness and limitation

The Soweto uprising began on 16 June 1976 amid opposition to apartheid education, including the imposition of Afrikaans as a medium of instruction.

Black Consciousness encouraged psychological liberation and black self-reliance. Explain its influence without reducing a broad movement to one slogan.

Civil resistance involved multiple organisations, communities and methods. Historical arguments should show change over time and recognise different forms of mobilisation.

### Selected context and mobilisation

| Period | Development | Connection to investigate |
|---|---|---|
| Late 1960s–1970s | Black Consciousness | identity and political awareness |
| 1976 | Soweto uprising | student resistance and repression |
| 1980s | broader civic mobilisation | community and organisational networks |

## 02 Follow the reasoning

Plan a paragraph on why education became a focus of resistance in 1976.

1. Make a claim: unequal apartheid education and the language policy provoked student opposition.

2. Support it with relevant contextual evidence, including student mobilisation and the events beginning on 16 June.

3. Explain how the evidence supports the claim; do not imply that language was the only grievance or that all participants had identical motives.

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# Practise with purpose

## 03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Give the date associated with the start of the Soweto uprising.

2. Name one limitation of using a single later oral-history interview.

3. What distinguishes an argument from a list of events?

## 04 Check and correct

1. 16 June 1976.

2. Memory, later experience and the interview setting may shape the account; corroboration is needed.

3. An argument makes a defensible claim, selects relevant evidence and explains its significance.

## Common mistake to avoid

These notes are a topic introduction, not an exhaustive essay or a substitute for analysing the sources supplied in an exam.

## Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

## Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Civil resistance in South Africa, 1970s–1980s

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: History. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID hist-12.